

Chapter 40-1

The actors who came for auditions would be divided into groups to enter the audition room.

Each group had two to three people.

Unfortunately, Liang Shi and Chen Liuying were assigned to the same group.

Even though she felt disdain for Chen Liuying in her heart, Liang Shi didn't show it on the surface. When she saw Chen Liuying and Bai Weiwei, she even nodded slightly as a greeting.

But Chen Liuying snorted lightly and rolled her eyes, while Bai Weiwei acted as if she hadn't seen anything.

Liang Shi: "..."

She felt that with Chen Liuying's personality, she would truly be cannon fodder¹ in the entertainment industry.

However, Liang Shi didn't take this to heart.

They were strangers to begin with.

This production crew had high standards. Even for auditions, they borrowed the stage of Qingcheng Grand Theater, and the audition venue was on the stage itself.

Generally speaking, stage plays were much more difficult than filming in a crew.

Not only would the audience give feedback on the spot, but there were also simple props, lines and actions that couldn't go wrong, positioning errors that weren't allowed—unlike filming in a crew where they could call "cut" again and again.

But when Liang Shi and the others came to audition, it wouldn't be as strict as an actual stage play.

They just had to perform on stage while a row of people sat below seriously watching, which was still quite stressful.

Especially since this row of people were all industry bigwigs.

After Liang Shi entered, she saw Zhao Ying sitting beside the director. Zhao Ying's gaze also looked over, and Liang Shi smiled and nodded as a greeting.

Incidentally, she also saw the woman who had been wearing casual clothes outside earlier. She was sitting at the edge of the second row, not next to Zhao Ying, not with anyone else, sitting alone by herself. She had now taken off her hat and let her long hair fall loose, strikingly beautiful in an aggressive way.

Liang Shi only glanced once before looking away.

Mainly because she had just looked up the name Yang Shuyan outside, and the accompanying tags were "Best Actress," "Child Star," "Imperial Alpha²," and "Acting Dynasty."

In comparison, what surprised her more was that Zhao Ying was actually an Omega.

Unlike Chen Liuying, Liang Shi came alone and, based on previous experience, went on stage by herself.

Meanwhile, Bai Weiwei instructed Chen Liuying from below the stage, telling her to take it slow and show her true abilities, until the director became impatient and frowned, asking, "Are you going to perform or not? If not, call the next one."

Only then did Bai Weiwei respond: "Coming."

Chen Liuying unhurriedly went on stage.

The audition segment was designated by the director. She and Chen Liuying would perform for each other, acting out the same segment.

The director had designated exactly the segment that Liang Shi had practiced with Xu Qingzhu last night.

Actually, it wasn't really Liang Shi's good luck.

Any actor who had read the script thoroughly could tell at a glance where the climax of this script was, where the plot that could best demonstrate an actor's layered acting skills was located.

Since she and Chen Liuying were strong competitors for this role, they would definitely be asked to perform the key scenes.

Liang Shi had made complete preparations, so naturally she wasn't afraid at this moment.

However, there was a disagreement about who should go first.

According to the numbers, Liang Shi should go first.

But Chen Liuying requested to perform first.

After asking for Liang Shi's opinion, the director agreed to the switch.

Liang Shi didn't mind either way. Performing first or last was the same to her; she didn't quite understand what Chen Liuying's intention was.

However, she professionally supported Chen Liuying's performance.

The supporting role should be the female lead, which was the character Zhao Ying was about to play.

As the resilient and strong female character in the drama, who valued relationships and took responsibility, she discovered she had been betrayed by someone she trusted completely. After being betrayed, she quickly adjusted her state and began to counterattack.

This scene was the confrontation after the counterattack.

A very long passage of dialogue.

The director also asked: "Miss Liang, do you need the script? You can bring it."

"No need, thank you." Liang Shi politely declined.

"You remember it?" The director was surprised.

You should know that there hadn't been a single actor before who could remember the other person's lines.

Wasn't she just showing off?

"My script doesn't allow for changed lines," the director's tone became somewhat stern. "If you deliberately use this method to cause your partner to make mistakes, no matter how well you perform, I won't use you."

Liang Shi smiled slightly, "Please rest assured, I won't do that."

After saying this, she paused and said seriously and reverently: "Acting requires mutual achievement."

The director was stunned for two seconds. He neither praised nor criticized, but simply said: "Begin."

Footnotes:

¹ **Cannon fodder:** A term from Chinese web novels referring to a minor character destined to fail or die, typically used to advance the main characters' story.

² **Imperial Alpha:** A term from ABO (Alpha-Beta-Omega) dynamics referring to an extremely dominant and powerful Alpha character, often used to describe top-tier Alphas in the hierarchy.